

FUTUREREADY NYC • NYCPS OFFICE OF STUDENT PATHWAYS

RECRUITMENT & **RETENTION** PLAYBOOK

A school-year action guide for FRNYC teams.
Grade by grade. Month by month. Aligned to KIMs.

RECRUITMENT & RETENTION PLAYBOOK

WHAT THIS PLAYBOOK IS FOR

This playbook guides FRNYC school teams through what to do — grade by grade, month by month — to build a full, equitable cohort and retain students through credential completion. Each activity is linked to its relevant KIM checkpoint so teams can see how their work connects to accountability. FRNYC places students in career pathways combining Work-Based Learning (WBL), college-credit coursework (ECC), and industry credentials. Enrollment officially begins in 10th grade; 8th–9th grade is for awareness and interest alignment.

KIM CHECKPOINTS — SCHOOL YEAR OVERVIEW

CHECKPOINT A Oct 5, 2025 Cohort in STARS · Fall CCI enrolled · Equity & support plans · WBL intermediary confirmed	CHECKPOINT B Jan 5, 2026 First 1:1 advising complete · First unpaid WBL captured · Spring ECC planning confirmations	CHECKPOINT C Apr 5, 2026 11th–12th ECC enrolled · 9th career exploration enrolled · Seniors: paid WBL accepted	CHECKPOINT D Jul 5, 2026 All completions locked · 2nd 1:1 done · Career plans filed · Year-end reflection & next-SY planning
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Note: "KIM checkpoint" replaces the term "milestone" to avoid confusion with the formal KIM system. The KIM column on each grade page shows which specific KIM each activity supports.

WHAT SUCCESS LOOKS LIKE IN SCHOOLS — 5 CORE PRINCIPLES OF RECRUITMENT

1. TIMING Recruitment is year-round, starting before students enter high school. Programs that delay until 10th grade struggle to enroll genuinely interested students. Strong programs begin in 8th grade and build through 9th.	2. INTEGRATION Programs embedded in advisory, courses, and school culture see stronger enrollment and persistence. Programs that operate as separate add-ons struggle with both recruitment and retention.
3. SOCIAL PROOF Students are most influenced by other students. Peer-to-peer communication builds trust, makes pathways feel real, and increases interest and enrollment across all grades.	4. RELEVANCE Students enroll and stay when they understand what they will do, what they will gain, and how it connects to their future. Lead with concrete outcomes — not abstract language like "career readiness."
5. EQUITY Students with disabilities and multilingual learners are often underrepresented due to structural barriers — not lack of interest. Strong programs track representation, identify barriers, and address them before they become attrition. See the Equity Checklist on the final page. Linked to KIMs A6 and D31.	

"Lead with what students get — a real-world WBL experience (internship, job shadow, or workplace simulation), college credit, or an industry-recognized credential before graduation — not with what FRNYC is or does. Schools that lead with the program name struggle; schools that lead with student outcomes recruit."

PRE-KIM AWARENESS & OUTREACH

8TH GRADE

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Goal: 8th graders and their families know your school is a FRNYC school and are interested enough to choose it. Activities here are strategically essential even though direct KIM measurement begins in 10th grade.

WHEN	ACTIVITY	PURPOSE & SUCCESS	AUDIENCE	POINT PERSON	CATEGORY	KIM ALIGNMENT
SEPT-OCT	Promote FRNYC on all school materials	Add "Future Ready NYC" and FRNYC logos to website, flyers, and social posts. Lead with outcomes students earn: ECC credits, WBL experience, industry credentials. <i>Success: Visitors know you're a FRNYC school before they arrive.</i>	Prospective families	FRNYC Coordinator	Recruitment	No direct KIM Supports equity outreach intent of A6
OCT-FEB	Ambassador-led open house	Brief 2–3 current FRNYC students using the Ambassador Script. Assign to small groups — conversation beats a stage presentation. Each ambassador shares one concrete outcome they earned. <i>Success: 8th graders hear a real outcome from a current student.</i>	Prospective students (8th grade)	FRNYC Coordinator	Recruitment	No direct KIM Pipeline to A3 cohort identification
OCT-FEB	Feeder school outreach + invite to FRNYC event	Contact 3–5 feeder school counselors; offer a campus tour or ambassador visit. Invite prospective 8th graders to a student showcase or career fair — no application required. <i>Success: 2+ feeder visits done; prospective students see FRNYC in action.</i>	Prospective students & families	FRNYC Coordinator	Recruitment	No direct KIM Supports equitable pipeline intent of A6

Year 0 tip: Start with your own students first. Identify 2–3 excited 10th or 11th graders and prepare them as ambassadors before any external outreach. Teach each to share: one outcome earned, one thing learned, and why they chose this pathway. They are your most powerful recruitment asset.

KIM REFERENCE — 8TH GRADE

A6

Plan to equitably recruit and support historically underserved groups — nearest formal KIM anchor for 8th-grade outreach

A3

10th–12th graders identified in STARS — the downstream outcome these recruitment activities are building toward

EXPLORATION & INTEREST ALIGNMENT → COHORT CONVERSION

9TH GRADE

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Goal: Every 9th grader explores career options and can say whether FRNYC fits. Cohort confirmed and orientation done before end of year. Cleanest KIM chain: C20 → D32 → D34 → D30.

WHEN	ACTIVITY	PURPOSE & SUCCESS	AUDIENCE	POINT PERSON	CATEGORY	KIM ALIGNMENT
SEPT-JUNE	Career Explorations — all 9th graders	Cover multiple career areas; ask "Which connects to something you care about?" By end of the unit, each student names one career area that interests them and one reason why. <i>Success: Every 9th grader can say whether FRNYC fits. Students self-identify interest.</i>	Enrolled 9th graders	Pathway Teacher	Recruitment	C20 9th enrolled in career exploration D37 9th completed career exploration
OCT & MAR	Ambassador visits to 9th grade advisories	Two visits per year (fall and spring) using the Advisory Slide Deck. Ambassadors share one thing they've done and one thing they've earned. <i>Success: Every 9th grader has 2+ direct FRNYC exposures before the survey.</i>	Enrolled 9th graders	FRNYC Coordinator	Recruitment	No direct KIM Builds pipeline to D30
NOV OR FEB	Parent-student panel	Current FRNYC students share what they've done; parents hear directly and ask questions. Format: 3–4 students, 30–45 minutes, Q&A included. <i>Success: Parents can describe one concrete outcome students earn in FRNYC.</i>	9th grade families	FRNYC Coordinator	Recruitment	No direct KIM Supports equity intent of A6
END OF MARCH	Interest survey — all 9th graders	Google Form to every 9th grader — required (Yes / No / Maybe); each student writes 1–2 sentences explaining their choice. Coordinator follows up with non-responders within 5 days. <i>Success: 100% response rate; sorted list by end of March.</i>	Enrolled 9th graders	FRNYC Coordinator	Recruitment	D32 9th graders completed career interest survey in digital tool
APRIL	1:1 meetings with interested students	1:1 with each interested student; survey response is the agenda. Cross-reference with master schedule — scheduling conflicts get a conversation, not an exclusion. <i>Success: Every interested student has had a documented 1:1 by end of April.</i>	Interested 9th graders	School Counselor	Recruitment	D34 9th graders completed 1:1 with college & career advisor
BY MAY	Orientation for rising 10th graders + parent session	Rising 10th graders meet their pathway teacher and cohort. Same-day parent session covers what students will earn and key dates for the year ahead. <i>Success: Rising 10th graders enter September knowing their pathway, cohort, and teacher.</i>	Confirmed students & families	FRNYC Coordinator	Recruitment	D30 Rising 10th graders identified in STARS

Timing matters: Deploy the survey by end of March — not May. This gives you April for real 1:1 conversations and time to complete orientation before year-end. "Maybe" triggers a follow-up conversation, not an exclusion.

COHORT LAUNCH & DEEP ENGAGEMENT

10TH GRADE

Goal: Students are officially in FRNYC as a cohort. WBL experiences align with CCI coursework. Peer community and identity form. All students identified in STARS and enrolled in Fall CCI by Checkpoint A (Oct 5).

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WHEN	ACTIVITY	PURPOSE & SUCCESS	AUDIENCE	POINT PERSON	CATEGORY	KIM ALIGNMENT
SEPT	STARS enrollment + cohort launch event	Confirm all FRNYC 10th graders identified in STARS. Hold an inaugural event (assembly or cohort lunch) — welcome students by name; older FRNYC students share one thing they've done or earned. <i>Success: Every student in STARS; students feel publicly welcomed into FRNYC.</i>	Enrolled 10th graders	FRNYC Coordinator	Retention	A3 Cohort in STARS A8 Fall CCI enrolled
SEPT-OCT	Align WBL with CCI via intermediary partner	Share CCI course overview with the WBL intermediary partner (assigned by OSP) at semester start — they arrange all placements; schools do not place students directly. Confirm 100% of students have a pathway-aligned WBL placement by October. <i>Success: Every student sees the connection between coursework and real-world experience.</i>	Enrolled 10th graders	FRNYC Coordinator	Retention	B17 First unpaid WBL captured D43 Two unpaid WBL activities completed
MONTHLY	Monthly FRNYC community time	30–60 minutes during advisory, lunch, or after school using the Cohort Meeting Guide. If students span multiple CCI sections, use this time to unite them — cross-section peer network is the primary retention driver. <i>Success: Students attend consistently; peer relationships deepen across sections.</i>	Enrolled 10th graders	FRNYC Coordinator	Retention	No direct KIM Sustains engagement tracked by B15
PER SEMESTER	Family checkpoint events	One event per semester — showcase, career panel, or Career Discovery Week. Answer four questions: What will my student earn? What skills? What real-world experience? What's the post-graduation benefit? Translate all materials into top 3 home languages. <i>Success: Parents can describe what their student is earning in the program.</i>	Families of enrolled students	FRNYC Coordinator	Retention	No direct KIM Supports equity intent of A6

KIM REFERENCE — 10TH GRADE (CHECKPOINT A BY OCT 5)

A3 All FRNYC 10th–12th graders identified in STARS **A8** All FRNYC 10th–12th enrolled in grade-appropriate Fall CCI

B17 All 10th graders: first unpaid WBL activity captured in STARS (by Jan 5) **D43** All 10th graders: two pathway-aligned unpaid WBL activities completed (by Jul 5)

ACADEMIC SUPPORTS, ADVISING & ECC PERSISTENCE

11TH GRADE

Goal: Academic supports that help students meet ECC eligibility requirements are scheduled into the school day — not offered as optional add-ons. Every student builds a post-secondary plan grounded in their FRNYC experience.

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WHEN	ACTIVITY	PURPOSE & SUCCESS	AUDIENCE	POINT PERSON	CATEGORY	KIM ALIGNMENT
SEPT–OCT	ECC eligibility audit + support planning	Identify who needs support to meet ECC eligibility (placement scores, GPA, or prerequisites set by the ECC partner). AP of Instruction schedules tutoring or Regents prep inside the school day. Coordinate all deadlines directly with the ECC partner institution. <i>Success: Every student has a clear ECC path; support plan in place by Oct 5.</i>	Enrolled 11th graders	AP of Instruction	Retention	A7 Academic supports plan C24 ECC enrolled Fall/Spring
JAN	First structured 1:1 advising + early intervention	Structured 1:1 with college & career advisor connecting CCI and WBL work to post-graduation goals. Warning signals: 3+ missed sessions, declining CCI/ECC grades, or expressed disinterest → 1:1 within 1 week; document discussion and commitments. <i>Success: All students have had first advising 1:1 by January 5.</i>	Enrolled 11th graders	School Counselor	Retention	B15 First 1:1 with college & career advisor
FEB–MAY	Group sessions + ongoing early intervention	2+ structured group sessions per year connecting CCI and WBL work to post-graduation goals. Maintain attendance list; flag anyone who misses 2+. No student exits without a documented conversation first. <i>Success: Attendance tracked; every at-risk student has a documented intervention note.</i>	Enrolled 11th graders	FRNYC Coordinator	Retention	A7 Supports plan D40 ECC completion
BEFORE JUNE	Second 1:1 + post-secondary plan documented	Ask each student: "Based on your FRNYC work, what do you want after graduation?" Document each student's plan: WBL experiences, ECC courses completed, and intended next step (college, career, or both). Use Post-Secondary Planning Template from OSP. <i>Success: Every student has a documented post-secondary intention before school ends.</i>	Enrolled 11th graders	School Counselor	Retention	D33 Second 1:1 complete D36 Written career planning reflection

KIM REFERENCE — 11TH GRADE

- A7** Plan for academic supports (by Oct 5) **B15** First 1:1 advising complete (by Jan 5) **C24** ECC enrollment confirmed Fall/Spring (by Apr 5)
- D33** Second 1:1 complete (by Jul 5) **D36** Written career planning reflection (by Jul 5) **D40** ECC completion for 11th–12th graders (by Jul 5)
- D44** Paid WBL completion benchmark for 11th grade (by Jul 5) **D45** Paid WBL planning for 11th grade holdouts (by Jul 5)

COMPLETION & AMBASSADOR PIPELINE

12TH GRADE

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Goal: Every enrolled student earns their credential before graduation. At-risk students are identified in September — not April. Completers become next year's ambassadors. The cycle renews.

WHEN	ACTIVITY	PURPOSE & SUCCESS	AUDIENCE	POINT PERSON	CATEGORY	KIM ALIGNMENT
SEPTEMBER	KIM review — on-track vs. needs-support list	Pull each student's ECC record from the KIM system — on-track vs. needs-support. Data not in the system won't count toward accountability. By October 1: every at-risk student has a written completion plan — Coordinator tracks, Principal is accountable. <i>Success: Every student's ECC status is known by October 1.</i>	Enrolled 12th graders	FRNYC Coordinator	Retention	A7 At-risk support plan Protects D40 ECC completion
ONGOING	ECC partner coordination	Name a direct contact at the ECC partner institution; know all enrollment, withdrawal, and grade reporting deadlines. When a student is at risk, contact the ECC liaison directly — don't wait for grades; ask about support or withdrawal options before mid-semester, when options narrow. <i>Success: No credit lost due to a missed administrative deadline.</i>	School / ECC partner	FRNYC Coordinator	Retention	B16 Spring ECC planning confirmations D41 ECC partner planning next SY D42 Fall ECC roster submitted
JAN–APR	Completion push + ambassador recruitment	January: verify ECC progress via KIM system; weekly check-ins for anyone behind — name exactly what to complete and by when. Recruit 3–5 completing seniors as ambassadors — ask directly; their role: open house, advisory visits, share their FRNYC experience. <i>Success: 90%+ earn credential before graduation; 3+ ambassadors confirmed.</i>	Enrolled 12th graders	FRNYC Coordinator	Both	C25 Seniors: paid WBL accepted/confirmed D40 ECC completion D46 Seniors: paid WBL completed
BEFORE JUNE 30	End-of-year debrief	Coordinator + AP + Counselor: review % who completed, where drop-offs occurred, 3 specific changes for next cycle. File the debrief before June 30 — findings shape next fall's open house and feeder school priorities. <i>Success: Written debrief on file; 3 changes identified for next year.</i>	School staff	FRNYC Coordinator	Both	D29 Next-SY implementation plan D31 Equity reflection complete

KIM REFERENCE — 12TH GRADE

- A7** At-risk student support plans (by Oct 5) **B16** Spring ECC planning confirmations (by Jan 5) **C25** Seniors: paid WBL accepted/confirmed (by Apr 5)
- D40** ECC completion for 11th–12th graders (by Jul 5) **D41** ECC partner planning for next SY (by Jul 5) **D42** Fall ECC roster submitted (by Jul 5)
- D46** Seniors: paid WBL completed (by Jul 5) **D29** Next-SY budget & implementation plan approved (by Jul 5)
- D31** Equity reflection on recruitment/support of underserved students (by Jul 5)

EQUITY CHECKLIST — SWD & MLL ACCESS (REVIEW AT ENROLLMENT AND MID-YEAR)

Underrepresentation is a structural problem — not a preferences problem. Review each barrier below at enrollment and again at mid-year. Linked to **A6** and **D31**.

BARRIER TO WATCH FOR	WHAT TO DO
IEP mandated services or pull-out schedules create conflicts that block SWD students from the cohort — often without anyone flagging it	Cross-reference the Yes/Maybe survey list with the master schedule before the cohort is finalized. Students blocked by scheduling get a 1:1 — explore period swaps, modified pull-outs, or an alternate CCI section. Flag to AP before cohort is finalized.
Open house materials, interest survey, and pathway descriptions are English-only	Translate all core materials (open house flyer, interest survey, orientation communication) into the top 3 home languages. Request translation support from ENL or your network office. Recruit bilingual student ambassadors.
ECC partner prerequisites may screen out SWD and MLL students who actually qualify via different pathways	Audit prerequisite lists annually. Identify what is a confirmed partner requirement vs. an internal assumption that can be challenged. Escalate structural barriers to your AP and OSP.
SWD / MLL enrollment in FRNYC is significantly below their share of the school population	Set an explicit equity target before each cycle — if SWD is 20% of 9th grade, aim for 20% of the FRNYC cohort. Actively recruit early, knowing some may face barriers later. Escalate significant gaps to school leadership and OSP before October 1.

KIM CROSSWALK — ALL GRADES AT A GLANCE

KIM	KIM DESCRIPTION	DUE	GRADE	PLAYBOOK ACTIVITY
A3	All FRNYC 10th–12th graders identified in STARS	Oct 5	10th	STARS enrollment + cohort launch
A6	Plan to equitably recruit and support underserved students	Oct 5	All	Outreach materials, open house, feeder schools, translations, equity targets
A7	Plan for remediation and academic supports	Oct 5	11th, 12th	ECC eligibility audit + KIM review (12th)
A8	All FRNYC students enrolled in grade-appropriate Fall CCI	Oct 5	10th	STARS enrollment + cohort launch
B15	All FRNYC students completed first 1:1 with college & career advisor	Jan 5	11th	First structured 1:1 advising
B17	All 10th graders: first unpaid WBL activity captured in STARS	Jan 5	10th	WBL alignment with intermediary
C20	All 9th graders enrolled in career exploration course	Apr 5	9th	Career Explorations (all 9th graders)
C24	All FRNYC 11th–12th enrolled in pathway-aligned ECC	Apr 5	11th	ECC eligibility audit + support planning
C25	All FRNYC 12th graders: pathway-aligned paid WBL accepted/confirmed	Apr 5	12th	Completion push (Jan–Apr)
D30	All rising 10th graders identified in STARS	Jul 5	9th	Orientation for rising 10th graders
D32	All 9th graders completed career interest survey in digital tool	Jul 5	9th	Interest survey (March)
D34	All 9th graders completed 1:1 with college & career advisor	Jul 5	9th	1:1 meetings with interested students (April)
D36	All FRNYC students: written career planning reflection complete	Jul 5	11th	Second 1:1 + post-secondary plan
D40	All FRNYC 11th–12th: completed pathway-aligned ECC	Jul 5	11th–12th	ECC supports + completion push
D43	All 10th graders: two pathway-aligned unpaid WBL activities completed	Jul 5	10th	WBL alignment with intermediary
D31	Review/reflection on equitably recruiting and supporting underserved students	Jul 5	All	End-of-year debrief + equity checklist
D29	Detailed budget and implementation plan for next SY approved	Jul 5	12th	End-of-year debrief